impossible unless the ruler publicly announces his disbelief.[4] For those waging a near enemy jihad, the bar is set much lower.

Morality-oriented activism describes a desire to reorient Muslims' social conduct in a more conservative direction and toward a more literalist interpretation of the Quran and Hadith. This is characterized by pietism in its non-violent form and vigilantism in its violent manifestation. Sectarian Islamism is defined by a desire to reduce the influence and power of a competing sect or sects. Violent sectarianism may aim to eliminate members of a competing sect altogether, or at least to cleanse a specific society of them. Like those motivated by state-oriented activism, sectarian and morality-oriented jihadis often look inward first, focusing on the population of the country in which they live.

Nation-oriented activism is characterized by a desire to establish sovereignty over specific territory perceived to be under non-Muslim occupation or domination. The designation of a specific piece of territory, as opposed to all territory under non-Muslim occupation or domination, suggests a nationalist as opposed to pan-Islamist orientation. This form of activism produces irredentist jihads. These are closest to the traditional Islamic rationale for war making, which encouraged Muslims to fight directly against infidels in order to liberate lands from foreign domination or protect Muslims under threat from an outside invader. Traditionally, this was an individual obligation only for Muslims living in the land in question, which is to say it was obligatory for all of them to participate. It was a collective obligation for all other Muslims, meaning the decision to participate was voluntary and that so long as some members of the umma answer the call, others need not fight. Thus, traditionally an irredentist jihad is inward looking and obligatory for Muslims living on the land in question and outward looking, but voluntary, for all other Muslims.

Umma-oriented activism is distinguished by a desire to protect the entire community of believers, known as the umma, from non-Muslim threats. It may produce a soft or violent form of pan-Islamism. Those with a pan-Islamist rationale for jihad face a bevy of potential enemies, and can be further sub-divided into classical jihadis and global jihadis. Classical jihadi doctrine is close to the traditional conception of irredentist jihad outlined above, but with a modern twist: today's classical jihadis believe all Muslims, as opposed to the population directly effected by a non-Muslim